

V05 SITE PLANNING AND SELECTION | O (MAX : 4 PT)

Intent : Promote movement, physical activity and active living through site and nearby amenities that facilitate walkability and provide proximate access to public transportation.

Summary : This WELL feature requires projects to demonstrate that the area around the building is fostering walkability and that the building is located near public transportation.

Issue : Over time, nearly every aspect of our built environment has been designed to demand and invite less movement – giving preference to sedentary activities, such as driving. ¹ In addition to interior active design, the context in which a WELL project is situated, including neighborhood and site-level factors, plays an integral role in physical activity opportunities and choices.²⁻⁶

Solutions : The impact of thoughtful site planning, design and selection reaches beyond positive impacts on physical activity and active living, improving nearly every aspect of community health and vitality from social well-being to economic development.⁷⁻⁹ There is no single metric or recipe that defines a walkable community. Features of walkable neighborhoods vary throughout the literature but centralize around several core design themes: proximity, connectivity, density, safety and aesthetics.¹⁰ Walkable communities consider the needs of diverse users and abilities and are designed to facilitate mobility across the lifespan. Communities can be evaluated at different scales, down to the street and building scale. Single buildings can actually have important contributions to the streetscape. Buildings that activate the first level by incorporating aesthetic design can make positive contributions to the pedestrian environment.^{11,12}

PART 1 SELECT SITES WITH PEDESTRIAN-FRIENDLY STREETS (MAX : 2 PT)

For All Spaces:

1: Pedestrian-friendly streets

At least one functional building entrance opens to a pedestrian network (i.e., streets where pedestrians travel featuring, at a minimum, sidewalks) and meets at least one of the following requirements:

- a. The project's address achieves a minimum Walk Score® of 70. To utilize this tool, projects must be located in a country that is "supported" by the tool.
- b. Opens onto a street with restricted vehicular traffic.¹⁴
- c. Within a 400 m distance of the project boundary, 90% of the total street length has continuous sidewalks on both sides and two of the following are met:
 1. At least eight existing use types (as defined in Appendix V1) are present.^{15,16}
 2. Speed limits of 40 kmh or less and street has buffer protections along sidewalks (e.g., curb extension, bioswales, bike lane, parked cars, benches, trees, planters).¹⁷⁻¹⁹
 3. Street segments intersect one another (excluding alleys) at least every 80-100 m.^{16,17}

2: Pedestrian-friendly environment

Exterior building walls facing the pedestrian network incorporate one or more of the following on the first floor or first 5.5 vertical m (whichever is less):^{17,20,21}

- a. Windows or glazing that provide transparency into the space.
- b. Overhangs such as canopies, awnings, eaves or shades.
- c. Murals or other artistic installations.
- d. Biophilic design elements (e.g., plants, water features, nature patterns, natural building materials).
- e. Mixed building textures, colors and/or other design elements.

Note : Interiors projects may count base building amenities toward feature requirements.

PART 2 SELECT SITES WITH ACCESS TO MASS TRANSIT (MAX : 2 PT)

For All Spaces:

The project meets at least one of the following requirements:²²

- a. The project's address achieves a minimum Transit Score® of 70. To utilize this tool, projects must be located in a country that is "supported" by the tool.
- b. Is located within a 200 m walk distance of existing bus network that provides at least 72 trips on each weekday and 30 trips on each weekend day.
- c. Is located within a 400 m walk distance of existing bus rapid transit stops, light or heavy rail stations, commuter rail stations or ferry services that provide at least 72 trips on each weekday and 30 trips on each weekend day.

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